



Microsoft unveils FastStart

FastStart, a new feature announced by Microsoft during E3 2018, applies machine learning and only downloads necessary parts of the game. <https://digit.in/jul18-44-1>



Alexa for couch potatoes

Amazon has unveiled their new TV streaming device which is almost completely handsfree! <https://digit.in/jul18-44-2>



Editing PC made to order

Agent001 dives deep while building a video editing PC for an old friend.

agent001 | agent001@digit.in

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he other day I got a call from an old friend of mine with whom I'd lost touch over the years. He'd recently

quit his job and wanted to join the bandwagon of entrepreneurs and enter the world of videography. Just like old friends who've never bothered to keep in touch with you, he proceeded straight to asking for hardware advice. Ah... well. A PC was needed, that too for video editing and he had the budget for it. He'd already started editing videos on his laptop but the export times were through the roof, hence the need for an upgrade.

As I went about asking him about his production pipeline, it dawned upon me that he makes absolutely no use of any special filters at all. At most, certain clients would request some garish filters to give it the classic Indian wedding video feel but that was about it. So naturally, I couldn't suggest the usual Killer Rig recommendation for the guy since the video editing rig makes use of a really good CPU and a GPU to strike a balance between core count and the GPU so that export times were reduced even if plenty of filters were used. However, if you aren't going to use many filters or effects in your video, then getting a powerful graphics card isn't prudent. The only outlier here would be if you are using a software that is optimised



for GPGPU. Then you're better off with the Killer Rigs recommendation.

There is a simple reason why you shouldn't base your rig purchase off of benchmarks because benchmarks, by definition, are built to make use of all the aspects of a software and push the hardware to its limits. This is a scenario which is not at all seen in real-world situations. Most amateurs simply perform jump cuts and add scene transitions. Essentially, all the GPU intensive tasks are kept to a minimum while CPU intensive tasks take up most of the edit process. This is with regards to every software out there except just one – DaVinci Resolve. Resolve makes use of the GPU

intensively and there's great benefit to be had for your edit process if you're using DaVinci Resolve. Running batch filters becomes more convenient if you have a good GPU while using DaVinci Resolve. For the most popular software such as Adobe Premiere Pro and Final Cut Pro, you're better off with a more powerful CPU and a normal GPU.

So now the question remains, what kind of GPU should you get? Is the GPU intensive task so minimal that you can make do with a simple RX 460 or GTX 1030? Turns out, that's not the case. Real world tests reveal that while performance does scale as you get a better GPU, the magnitude of